



USING GOOGLE CHROME WITH CORTANA

Usually when you ask Cortana any open-ended questions, it searches on Microsoft's Bing search engine and displays the results on Microsoft Edge. If you have changed your default browser, it simply doesn't display any answers. However, there is a workaround to force Cortana to use Google for web searches and display the results on Chrome. First, ensure that Google Chrome is your default browser on Windows 10. Next, install a free software called EdgeDeflector from Github (download link - <https://digit.in/EdgeDeflector>). Download the file, install it and then run EdgeDeflector.exe. After this, every open-ended question you ask Cortana will be answered on Chrome. Remember to get the latest version of EdgeDeflector from Github in case your current version stops working since it doesn't auto-update.

Now, for the second part of the conundrum. What do you do if you want Cortana to search via Google or other search engines? To change this, you will have to install the Chrometana extension for Google Chrome. After you add it to Chrome, a new tab will open asking you to choose your preferred search engine. You can choose between Google, DuckDuckGo, and Yahoo at the moment. Pick your search engine and from that point onwards the searches on Cortana will be done via your preferred search engine and not Bing. Note: For Chrometana to work, you need to first install EdgeDeflector. 



Alexa

Do more with Amazon's assistant

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THE ALEXA APP ON THE SMARTPHONE is great for commandeering an Echo device, but not that great as a native AI assistant. This is because of a more limited access to the functions of the device, and the need to physically open the app, then tap on the button to activate the voice features. Note that it is really helpful to have an Echo or other Alexa enabled devices connected to your smarthome gadgets to use the full potential of Alexa.



CHANGE THE WAKE WORD

If there is someone in your household or friend circle called Alex, the device will trigger a response every single time someone mentions Alex. To fix this, you can change the Wake Word used by Alexa to something else.

This has to be specified for every single device that you own, and cannot be done for the entire account. Fire up the app and go to Settings > Device Settings > Your Echo > Wake Word and change it to what you want. The Wake Word option is available towards the bottom of the list so you will have to scroll a bit. There are four options available, Alexa, Amazon, Echo and Computer. Star Trek fans can pick the last one.



CUSTOMISE YOUR SPORTS UPDATE

This is a nifty little trick that will get you the latest information from your favorite teams. It is most useful for tracking Football teams, but there are cricket updates available as well, including for the IPL. Go to Settings > Sport > Edit, then remove all the pre-populated teams and add in the teams that you want to track. Then tap on Add a Team and search for the teams that you want to add. Now, when you ask for a sports update, the lat-

est scores from these teams will be provided.



SETUP YOUR TRAFFIC UPDATE

You can choose to be informed on the traffic situation before your morning commute. To do so, you will first have to provide your home and office information to the app. Go to Settings > Traffic and enter in your work address. Your home address will already be there, derived from your account information. In case you regularly make stops on your morning commute, for example to pick up carpoolers, you can add as many pit stops as you please by tapping on the location marker between your work and your destination. Note that the location search feature is not very accurate, and at times outright useless in India, so you have to put in a complete address along with the PIN code. Once set up though, the traffic update works as intended. On an iPhone, there is an additional option to use Google Maps as the default navigation app instead of Apple Maps.